

Language Messaiah and Christ

July 24th, feast day of Saint Christina of Tyre. But what does her name mean? You will surely be surprised!

Of course, for scientific Christians, there is a great deal of blurriness as to her existence and where she was from, because besides Eastern accounts placing her in Tyre, Lebanon, Western accounts place her in Bolsena in Tuscany, Italy, and some place her in Persia, with different dates. That said besides Christina the Astonishing of Belgium.

Anyhow all accounts reflect a great faith leading to destroying pagan idols and being torured by her father and later beheaded. Of note, this pattern is repeated in various saints' stories of the early ages of Christianity. No smoke without fire? We leave that to the readers!

Still happy feast day for Christians and may we learn from her how to stand up for our beliefs, and especially our belief in Jesus who gave the loveliest recommendations for a better world 🙏

But let us discuss what Christ and the names Christian / Christina mean.

After Christ resurrected, the first followers from among the Jews used the term "Messaiah" as a byname, from the word "Masha7a", now said "Masa7a", a Canaanite (Phoenician as per the Greek name for Canaanites), and later Hebrew and Arabic, word, meaning "to wipe", "to anoint", because of this ritual that existed in the region, among Canaanites and later among Jews, for kings.

However, in Greece, the first followers there used another byname, "Christ", from the word "χρυσός" (Khrysós, sometimes erroneously spelled as "Chrysós"), which means "gold" in old and current Greek, because Jesus, like gold, "gave out light".

This is why nowadays, "Messaiah" is translated into "Christ", but the two words do not mean the same thing!

Cherry on top, like many words that entered the West coming from Canaan, all well attested before the Greek dark ages (1100 - 800 BC) and thus before all European languages, attested in Ugarit (1400 BC) and some even in Ebla (2500 BC), "chrysós" comes from "Khrrs" (خرص)* (Kharoos by the Hebrew approximation of vowelization), which meant "gold" in ancient Canaanite, and then, through the concept of bodily ornaments, "pearl beads".

* A millenium later, c. 500 BC, in their letter alphabet, Canaanites will write it as Hrs (حرص), possibly still pronouncing it as "Khrrs", after having written it as "Khrrs" using their earlier, mainly Ugaritic, cuneiform alphabet.

Hebrew still retains "חרוז" (Khurooz), and we in our current modern Canaanite language, wrongly labeled as Lebanese or Vernacular Arabic (dérij or 3ammiyyeh), we still hold "Kharzeh zar2a la saybit el 3ayn"!

Yes, our language that we speak nowadays gave both words, "Messaiah" and "Christ", millenia ago...